



Northbridge Community Alliance Brand & Communication Guidelines

Introduction

Northbridge Community Alliance (NCA) strengthens neighborhood resilience by expanding access to education, food security, workforce pathways, housing support, and environmental health.

These guidelines establish a consistent voice, tone, and communication standard across all internal and external messaging — including staff communications, volunteer outreach, policy briefs, grant proposals, and AI-assisted outputs.

Every message should reflect our mission:

Community-centered service. Evidence-based action. Respect for every individual.

Tone of Voice

Our tone balances professionalism with empathy. We communicate clearly, respectfully, and without jargon.

We speak with authority when referencing documented data or policy positions, but we never overstate our impact or make promises we cannot guarantee.

Our tone should be:

- **Respectful** – Center the dignity and agency of community members.
- **Clear** – Use plain language and short sentences.
- **Evidence-Informed** – Support claims with documented data when available.
- **Practical** – Emphasize next steps and available resources.
- **Non-Assumptive** – Avoid language that implies blame or stereotypes



Messaging Pillars

Northbridge communications should consistently reinforce three core themes:

1. Community-Centered Service

We exist to respond to documented community needs.

- Highlight accessibility and responsiveness.
- Emphasize collaboration with partners.
- Avoid portraying NCA as the sole solution.

2. Accountability & Transparency

We ground claims in documented outcomes and operational data.

- Reference measurable results when available.
- Acknowledge limitations or uncertainty.
- Avoid exaggeration.

3. Collaboration & Partnership

Northbridge works across neighborhoods and organizations.

- Use inclusive language.
- Emphasize shared responsibility.
- Avoid adversarial framing unless policy context requires it.

Style Guidelines

To ensure clarity and consistency:

- Use short paragraphs and bullet points.
- Prefer active voice.
- Avoid slang, clichés, or overly technical jargon.
- Use person-first language (e.g., “families experiencing food insecurity”).
- Be specific about next steps (“Call 555-1234 between 9am–4pm”).
- Do not speculate beyond documented evidence.

When citing data:

- Use specific metrics when available.
- Distinguish between observed outcomes and projected impact.
- Avoid implying causation unless documented.



Accessibility Standards

All public-facing content should:

- Use plain language.
- Include contact options (phone/email).
- Avoid acronyms unless defined.
- Be structured with headings or bullets for readability.
- Offer language support information when appropriate

Audience Guidelines

Northbridge communicates with several different stakeholder groups. While the overall tone remains consistent, the emphasis and examples should shift based on the audience.

Community Members

- Focus on clarity and next steps.
- Provide concrete resource information.
- Avoid institutional language.

Volunteers

- Emphasize appreciation and impact.
- Clearly outline expectations (time, location, requirements).
- Use direct and supportive language.

Funders & Grant Reviewers

- Emphasize measurable outcomes.
- Integrate documented impact metrics.
- Connect activities to broader community need.

Policy Stakeholders

- Lead with documented evidence.
- Clearly distinguish between data, interpretation, and recommendation.
- Avoid inflammatory language.





Required Disclaimers

The following disclaimers must appear whenever relevant:

For Intake & Service Guidance:

“This information provides general guidance based on available Northbridge resources. It does not replace professional legal, medical, or emergency services.”

For Urgent or Safety-Related Situations:

“If there is an immediate safety concern, please contact emergency services or follow established escalation protocols.”

For Policy or Advocacy Materials:

“This document reflects Northbridge’s interpretation of currently available data and community input. Policy conditions may change.”

For Grant or Impact Reporting:

“Impact metrics reflect documented program data during the reporting period and should be interpreted within the context described.”

AI-generated outputs must not omit relevant disclaimers.





Escalation & Risk Language

AI-generated content must:

- Escalate medical, safety, or emergency-related content.
- Avoid offering legal or medical advice.
- Avoid promising resource availability unless verified.
- Flag when information is incomplete.

Prohibited Language & Claims

Do not:

- Guarantee outcomes.
- Assign blame to individuals or communities.
- Make unsupported statistical claims.
- Provide instructions that substitute for licensed professionals.
- Suggest emergency handling outside official protocols.

Closing Notes

These guidelines apply to all communications, whether written by staff or generated by AI systems.

AI-assisted tools must be designed to:

- Align with tone and accessibility standards.
- Include required disclaimers.
- Ground claims in documented data.
- Escalate when appropriate.

By maintaining consistency in voice and responsibility in messaging, Northbridge ensures that every communication builds trust and reflects our mission.

